

Mid-semester Examinations Winter Semester 2024-25
Course: Understanding Human Behaviour
Part -C (Unit-3)

Total Marks = 10

Questions:

1. What are categories and concepts? Why do we need concepts? *(2 marks)*
2. List the influences of typicality on cognition. *(2 marks)*
3. What is the main difference between “*Prototype theory*” and “*Exemplar theory*”? *(1 mark)*
4. An online store lists a smartwatch with an "original price" of ₹15,000 but offers it at a "discounted price" of ₹7,500. Even if similar smartwatches are available for ₹7,000 elsewhere, customers perceive this as a great deal. Identify the cognitive bias in the above situation *(1 mark)* and explain *(1 mark)*.
5. Answer the following:
 - a) Explain the sunk cost fallacy. *(1 mark)*
 - b) Identify two psychological factors that contribute to the sunk cost fallacy. *(1 mark)*
6. What is confirmation bias? *(1 mark)*

Answers:

1. Category is a set of objects that can be treated as equivalent in some way *(0.5 marks)*, and concepts are mental representations we form of categories *(0.5 marks)*. Simplifying the complex world/ categorising/ communication of ideas/establishing order in our knowledge base *(at least 2; 1 mark)*
2. Typical items are judged category members more often; the speed of categorisation is faster for typical items; typical members are learned before atypical ones; learning a category is easier if typical examples are provided; in language comprehension, references to typical members are understood more easily; in language production, people tend to say typical items before atypical ones *(at least 4; 2 marks)*
3. According to the prototype view, individual instances are not specifically stored or mentally represented but instead averaged into some composite representation. The exemplar view of concepts makes just the opposite assumption, that is, it asserts that concepts include representations of at least some actual individual instances *(1 mark)*
4. Anchoring Bias *(1 mark)*: The initial starting point will have a huge effect on the final estimates, showing evidence of the phenomenon known as anchoring *(1 mark)*.
5. a) The sunk cost fallacy is the greater tendency to continue an endeavour once an investment in time, money, or effort has been made *(1 mark)*.

b) Psychological Factors: Reluctance to admit past errors *(0.5 mark)*, Desire for self-justification *(0.5 mark)*.
6. The tendency to pay attention primarily to information that confirms existing views or beliefs *(1 mark)*.